

Insurance-Linked Securities Market Insights

Edition XL, July 2026



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Introduction

The first half of 2026 has continued to reaffirm the Insurance-Linked Securities (ILS) market's role as a deep and resilient source of catastrophe risk capital. Following a record year of issuance in 2025, the market entered 2026 with strong momentum, supported by robust investor demand and a steady pipeline of new and returning sponsors seeking protection. Catastrophe bond issuance exceeded USD 17 billion across 64 transactions during the first half of the year, making H1 2026 the strongest first half on record and surpassing the previous high set in 2025.

Primary market activity remained broad, with repeat sponsors continuing to access the market for peak US wind, earthquake and multiperil protection, while first-time sponsors benefited from the market's continued ability to absorb both peak and diversifying risks. This momentum persisted even as risk spreads returned to pre-Hurricane Ian lows, with all-in yields remaining attractive relative to expected loss and returns available from traditional fixed income alternatives.

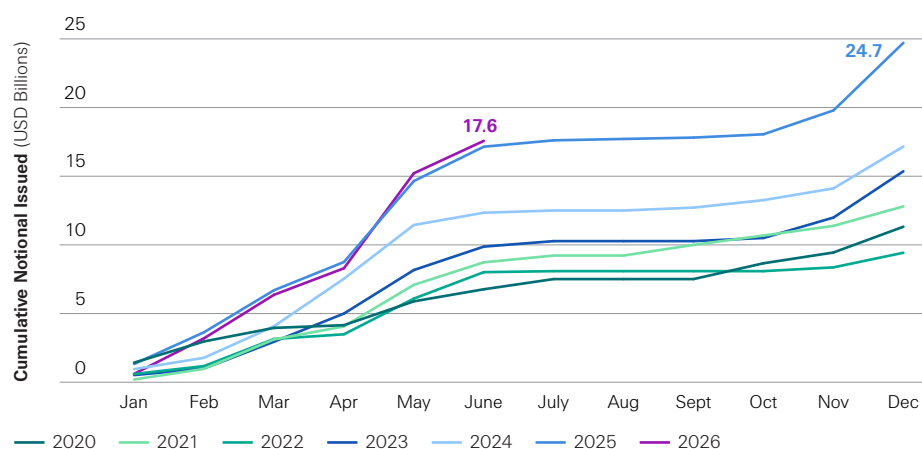
The market has also benefited from a relatively benign catastrophe environment. Global insured natural catastrophe losses during the first half of 2026 are expected to be below recent historical averages, and no major natural catastrophe event caused meaningful disruption to the catastrophe bond market. Against a backdrop of heightened macroeconomic uncertainty and ongoing geopolitical conflicts, catastrophe bonds continued to demonstrate low correlation with broader financial markets, reinforcing the asset class's appeal to investors seeking attractive risk-adjusted returns and portfolio diversification.

This edition of Insurance-Linked Securities Market Insights reviews primary and secondary market developments in the first half of 2026, provides an updated view on Swiss Re's catastrophe bond indices, and examines key themes shaping the market.



Primary market performance

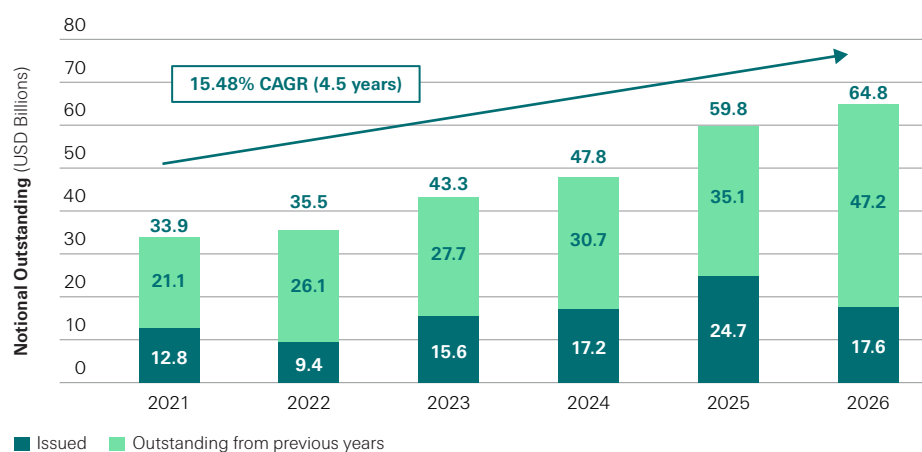
Figure 1
ILS New Issuance:
Historical Cumulative Notional Issued



Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

Following the record-breaking issuance year in 2025, the catastrophe bond market has continued to build on that momentum. Based on Swiss Re Capital Markets' (SRCM) Deal Database, gross issuance volume reached USD 17.6 billion, making H1 2026 the new largest half year issuance to date. Notably, active May issuance in both 2025 and 2026 underscores the market's increased reliance on the catastrophe bond market for the June 1 renewals, especially when sponsors observe favourable market conditions throughout the quarter.

Figure 2
Issued vs Outstanding Notional



Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

The continued years of heightened primary issuance volumes, outpacing maturities in the same timeframe, has resulted in further growth of the catastrophe bond market. As shown in Figure 2, total outstanding notional increased to USD 64.8 billion, up from USD 59.8 billion at year-end 2025, implying a 15.48% compound annual growth rate since 2021. This sustained expansion highlights the increasing relevance of ILS capacity as part of sponsors' broader risk transfer strategies, as well as continued investor demand for diversifying catastrophe risk.

The market observed various types of first-time sponsors, with 12 new sponsors securing coverage in the catastrophe bond market. ILS funds (e.g. Lumen, Integral) accessed the catastrophe bond market for industry loss index protection, continuing the trend recently established by One William Street. Sovereign governments (Tajikistan and the Kyrgyz Republic) were also among the first-time sponsors, alongside primary insurers seeking capacity to complement their traditional reinsurance programs.

Figure 3

First-time Catastrophe Bond Sponsors in 2026

First Time Sponsor	Deal	Notional (USD million)	Covered Peril
Lumen	Photon Re 2026-1	175	US WS (NE), US EQ
Integral	Windrose Re 2026-1	275	US WS
Plymouth Rock	Tremont Re 2026-1	100	US WS (NE)
Olympus	Abacab Re 2026-1	120	US WS (FL)
One Alliance North America Insurance Company	One Shield Re 2026-1	115	US WS (FL, GA, HI, NC, SC, TX), CA WF
Tajikistan	ADB Tajikistan 2026	80	EQ, Precipitation
Kyrgyz Republic	ADB Kyrgyz Republic 2026	80	EQ, Precipitation
People's Trust Insurance Company	GWS Re 2026-1	100	US WS (FL)
Mangrove Property Insurance	Buttonwood Re 2026-1	111	US WS (FL)
Oak Reinsurance (Syndicate 2843)	Quercian Re 2026-1	150	US WS, US EQ, US WF, CAN WS, CAN EQ
Gothaer	Yardstick Re 2026-1	114 ¹	DE FL
Syndicate 3123 (Fidelis Partnership)	Woody Re 2026-1	75	WS (US/PR/USVI/DC), EQ (US/PR/USVI/DC/CAN), ST/WF/WT (US/DC)

Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

Note: 1. USD equivalent using the EUR/USD exchange rate as of the date of settlement

In addition to first-time sponsors, the growth in outstanding notional was mainly driven by the established players. State Farm, Allstate, SageSure and USAA each issued catastrophe bonds in H1 2026 with notional exceeding each sponsor's respective scheduled maturities, increasing their outstanding catastrophe bond protection. The four sponsors collectively increased their outstanding notional by almost USD 3.0 billion³, materially contributing to the market's growth.

Figure 4

Top 10 Issuers H1 2026

Sponsor	H1 2026 Issuances	H1 2026 Maturities ¹	Notional Outstanding as of June 30, 2026 ²
State Farm	1500	0 ³	4500
Allstate	1400	764	3941
SageSure	845	480	1485
USAA	825	340	3465
TWIA	750	2150	1050
Travelers	750	575	750
Everest Re	630	330	1830
FL Citizens	600	1600	2125
NCJUA/NCIUA	600	350	1795
GeoVera	550	150	1175

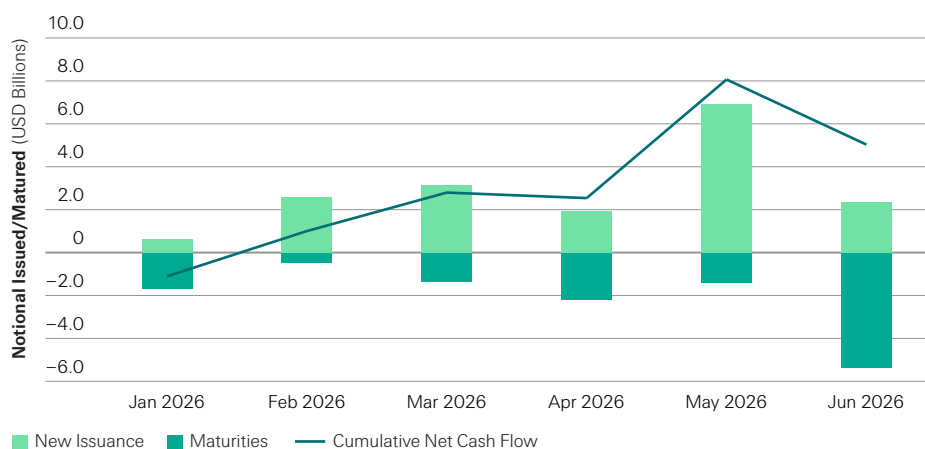
Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

Note: 1. Maturities account for partial redemptions and principle reductions, 2. Notional Outstanding includes H1 2026 Issuances, 3. Merna Re 2023-1 A and Merna Re 2023-2 A transactions are expected to mature on July 7, 2026 for a combined \$450m of notional

A contrasting trend was observed among several insurers of last resort, specifically Florida Citizens and the Texas Windstorm Insurance Association (TWIA), both of which issued total notional well below maturities. In Florida, the continued depopulation of the Florida Citizens portfolio has transferred policies back to the private insurance market, reducing the need for the insurer to maintain previous levels of protection. Reflecting this trend, Florida Citizens publicly indicated its intention to redeem the outstanding Everglades Re 2024-1 bonds before subsequently returning to the market with the 2026 issuance. The transaction's optional redemption feature permitted Florida Citizens to redeem USD 1.1 billion of outstanding bonds at a reduced Optional Redemption Premium, with the premium declining as the program's Total Insured Value (TIV) decreased relative to its initial level. As the reduction ultimately exceeded 15%, the bonds were redeemed at the minimum premium.

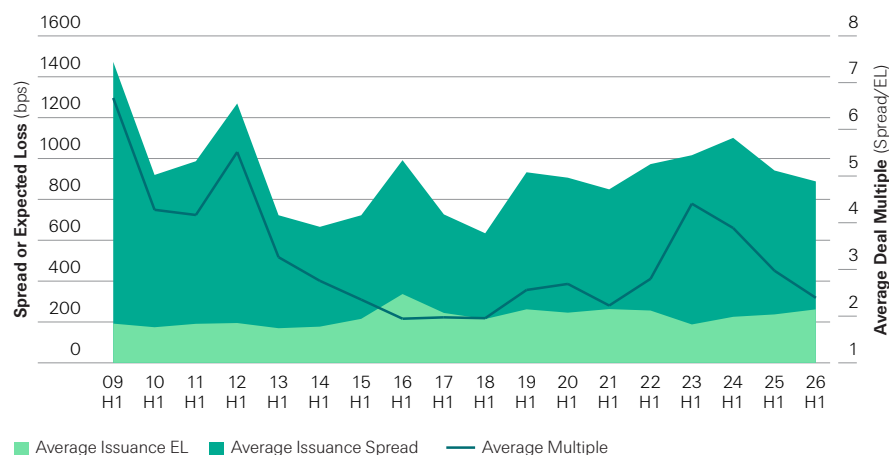
Similarly, TWIA made use of a change in law event to redeem certain bonds early. The law in question was the Texas state legislature reducing the minimum catastrophe funding requirement from a 1-in-100 year minimum probable maximum loss metric (PML), down to a 1-in-50-year PML. The change in legislation enabled TWIA to redeem a total of USD 1.25 billion across the Alamo Re 2024-1 and Bluebonnet Re 2025-1 series in June. These larger early redemptions, together with the USD 10.2 billion of scheduled maturities during the first half of the year, released significant investor capital to be made available for redeployment into new catastrophe bond issuances. Despite the large level of redemptions and maturities, Figure 5 shows that net cash flow into the catastrophe bond market remained firmly positive during H1 2026, with an estimated USD 5.0 billion of net new capital entering the market.

Figure 5
Net Cash Flow into the Catastrophe
Bond Market (New Issuance and Maturities)



Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

Figure 6
H1 Weighted Average Spread,
H1 Expected Loss and H1 Multiple

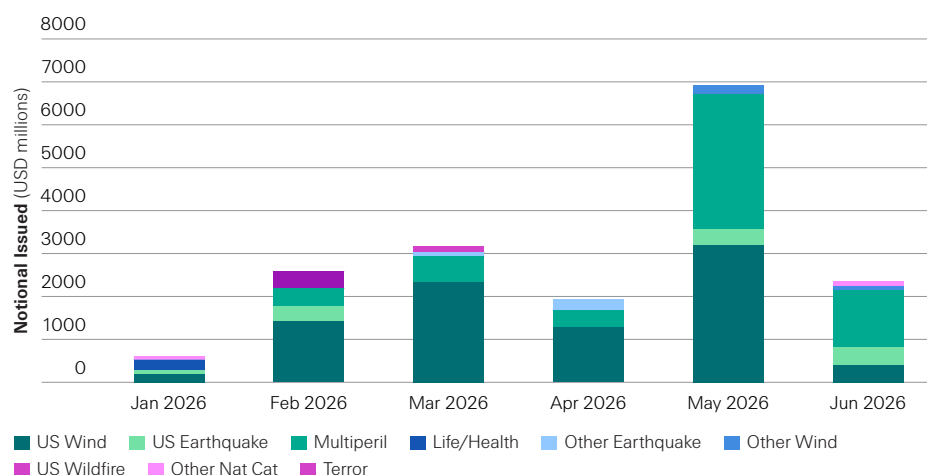


Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

Note: Includes nat-cat bonds issued in H1 of every year only, average weighted by issued notional, excludes bonds covering wildfire only, 2nd event, zero coupon bonds with duration of less than 9 months, as well as select Sanders Re, Topanga Re, Residential Re, Quercus Re, and Bonanza Re aggregate bonds

Pricing dynamics in H1 2026 reflected a market that remained well supported by investor capital, while still offering attractive risk-adjusted returns. Figure 6 shows weighted average issuance spreads continuing to tighten from elevated levels observed previously following a harder market cycle from 2022 through 2023. Consistent with this trend, the average multiple declined from H1 2025, reflecting the continued compression in risk spreads while expected loss levels increased slightly over the period.

Figure 7
2026 New Issuance by Peril Group



Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets Deal Database as of June 30, 2026

Note: Category determined by EL contribution, with a threshold of 90%. I.e., bonds with an EL contribution of over 90% from US wind will be classified as US wind. Multiperil bonds with no US exposure are classified as Other Nat Cat.

The composition of issuance in H1 2026 continued to be led by US wind, with over 50% of issuance in the first half of 2026 having more than 90% of expected loss ("EL") driven from US wind on a modelled basis. While US wind remained the dominant peril during the most active issuance months, the market also offered meaningful capacity for multiperil, US earthquake, international and/or wildfire-exposed transactions.

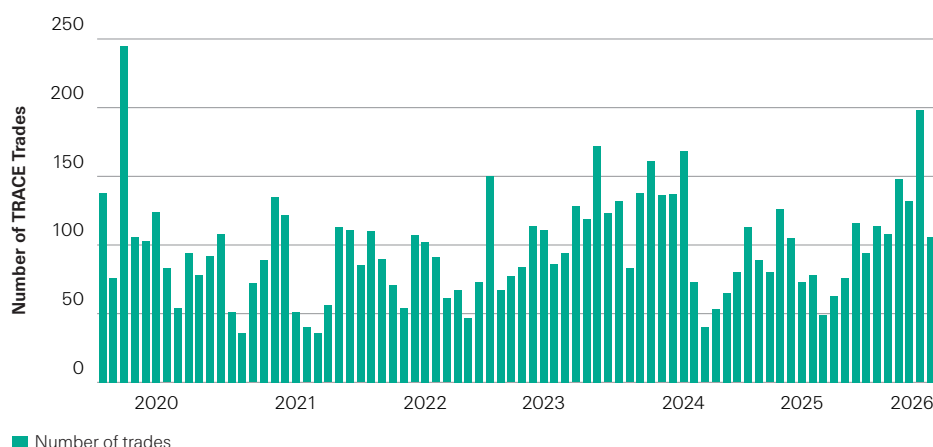
June issuance was more limited following the heavy activity in May, but still represented the second strongest June on record with USD 2.4 billion of issuance.

Under favourable market conditions in the broader reinsurance market, sponsors were keen to broaden the scope of coverage. While many transactions continue to cover the peak perils of US wind and US earthquake, a number of issuances now provide coverage for secondary perils, namely severe thunderstorm and/or US wildfire, on a remote, per occurrence basis. Although investors continue to exercise caution against the potential aggregation of frequency losses against annual aggregate structures, the above trend demonstrates the acceptance of such risk perils for select sponsors who have demonstrated the remoteness and integrity of the structure.



Secondary market summary

Figure 8
TRACE Trade Summary



Source: Trade Reporting and Compliance Engine ("TRACE") and Bloomberg LP as of June 30, 2026

Note: All TRACE Trades on the following dates have been excluded: October 5 2021, March 1 2022, May 23 2022, July 18 2022, January 23 2023, June 20th 2023, April 9 2024, May 7 2024, June 11 2024, August 21 2024, December 30 2024, January 2 2025, April 14 2025, April 24 2025, May 2 2025, May 7 2025, May 8 2025, May 16 2025, May 27 2025, June 5 2025, June 23 2025, June 30 2025, July 8 2025, July 18 2025, July 21 2025, July 23 2025, October 3 2025, December 22 2025, December 29 2025, May 29 2026. In addition, trades with 3 decimal places of precision have been excluded.

The secondary market remained bid-heavy with more market participants looking to buy bonds than sell out of their existing positions. Nevertheless, secondary market activity has increased meaningfully in the first six months of 2026 following a relatively subdued 2025. As shown in Figure 8 above, TRACE activity totalled 806 trades¹ through June 2026, exceeding the H1 2025 activity by 37.5%.

The increase in activity has been particularly evident since March, with TRACE volumes rising to 148 trades in March and 198 trades in May¹. According to TRACE data, May 2026 was the most active month in the secondary market since March 2020. In mid May, the catastrophe bond market experienced a particularly active and broad week of secondary market trading. Albeit generally in small volumes, 129 different bonds—around one third of the number of outstanding catastrophe bond classes—changed hands in the week of May 18 as reported on TRACE. The breadth of activity highlights the increased liquidity in a maturing secondary market. Investors are taking advantage of the liquidity of the product. In addition, TRACE reporting enhanced price transparency by providing all market participants transaction-based price references for the recently traded bonds.

¹ All TRACE Trades on the following date have been excluded: May 29 2026. In addition, trades with 3 decimal places of precision have been excluded.

Figure 9
US Windstorm, US Earthquake,
US Industry Loss, and
Non-Peak Spread Progression



Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets, as of June 30, 2026

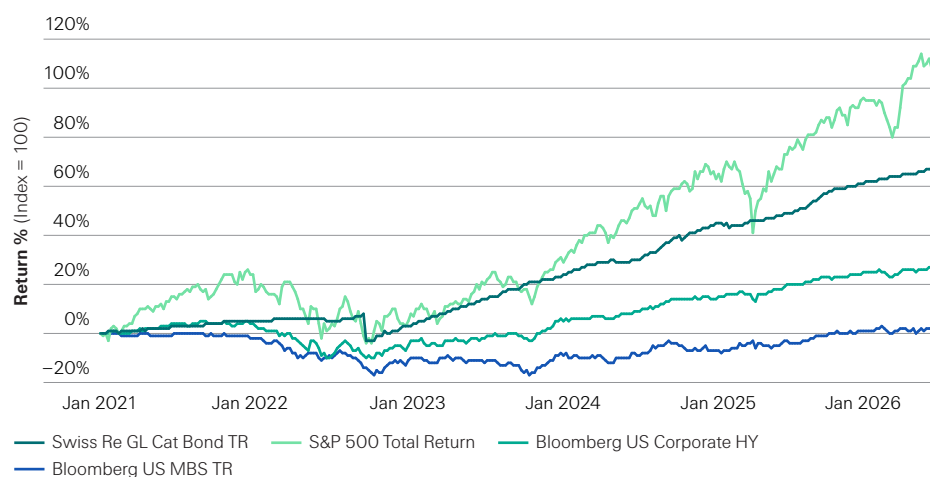
Note: Swiss Re Cat Bond Indices are based on indicative pricing only.

1. US WS BB Rated Comp contains bonds with at least 1 year to maturity that have nonzero exposure to US windstorm (US WS), and an EL between 16-180 bps (or with an actual BB rating, regardless of EL).
2. US EQ BB Rated Comp contains bonds with at least 1 year to maturity that have 100% exposure to US earthquake (US EQ), and an EL between 16-180 bps (or with an actual BB rating, regardless of EL).
3. NA IL BB Rated Comp contains bonds with at least 1 year to maturity that have 100% exposure to North America perils on a PCS index trigger basis, and an EL between 16-180 bps (or with an actual BB rating, regardless of EL).
4. Non-Peak BB Rated Comp contains bonds with at least 1 year to maturity that have 0% exposure to US WS or US EQ, and an EL between 16-180 bps (or with an actual BB rating, regardless of EL).
5. Seasonally-adjusted secondary spreads. Bonds with interest spread movement since issuance of greater than 200% or less than or equal to -100% have been excluded.
6. Non-natural catastrophe bonds have been excluded. Bonds with 90% or greater contribution to EL from Wildfire have been excluded. Sanders Re aggregate bonds have been excluded.
7. Bonanza Re 2020-2 B, 2021-1 B, 2023-1 B; Topanga Re 2021-1 B; Herbie Re 2020-1 A; Everglades Re 2023-1 A, 2023-2 A; Wrigley Re 2023-1 B; Aragonite Re 2024-1 A; Marlon 2024-1 B have all been excluded.

The trend of seasonally adjusted secondary spreads is illustrated above in Figure 9 for select baskets of catastrophe bonds. US Wind spreads continued the tightening trend observed through much of 2025, with continued investor demand and limited loss activity impacting outstanding bonds. In contrast, US Earthquake spreads increased over the first half of the year, while Industry Loss spreads remained relatively flat. Overall, spread movements across the three groups of catastrophe bonds have become more moderate relative to the larger movements observed post-Hurricane Ian.

Insights into the Swiss Re catastrophe bond indices

Figure 10
Swiss Re Index Comparison



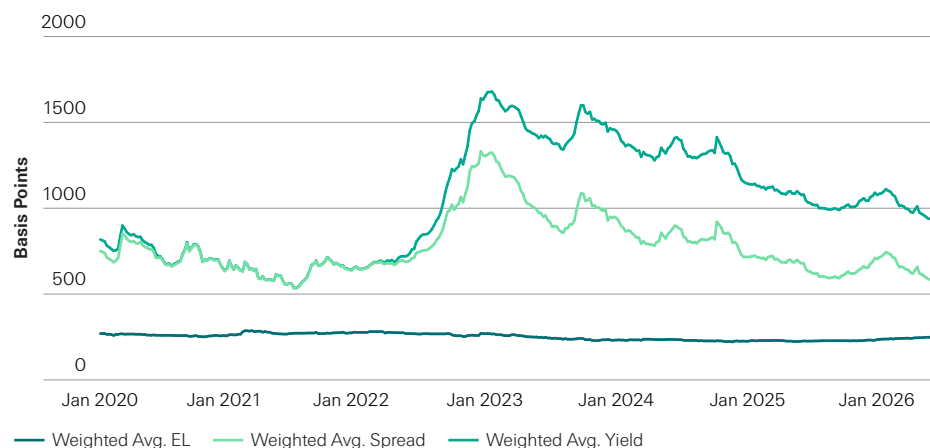
Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets and Bloomberg LP as of June 30, 2026

Note: Swiss Re Global Cat Bond TR (SRGLTRR Index), S&P 500 Total Return (SPXT Index), Bloomberg US Corporate HY (LF98TRUU Index), Bloomberg US MBS TR (LUMSTRUU Index). Swiss Re Cat Bond Indices are based on indicative pricing only.

Despite continued uncertainty across global financial markets during the first half of the year, including ongoing geopolitical tensions, evolving trade policy and heightened volatility across traditional asset classes, the catastrophe bond market has once again demonstrated its low correlation to broader financial markets and other alternative asset classes. The Swiss Re Global Catastrophe Bond Index (SRGLTRR) has returned 4.12% over the first half of this year.

Weighted average spreads have continued tightening over the first half of 2026, reflecting continued strong investor demand and a well-capitalized market. At the same time, elevated money market rates continue to provide meaningful support to all-in yields, which remain attractive relative to the lower rates observed in previous years.

Figure 11
Weighted Average Yield/Spread/MMY of the Swiss Re Global Catastrophe Bond Total Return Index

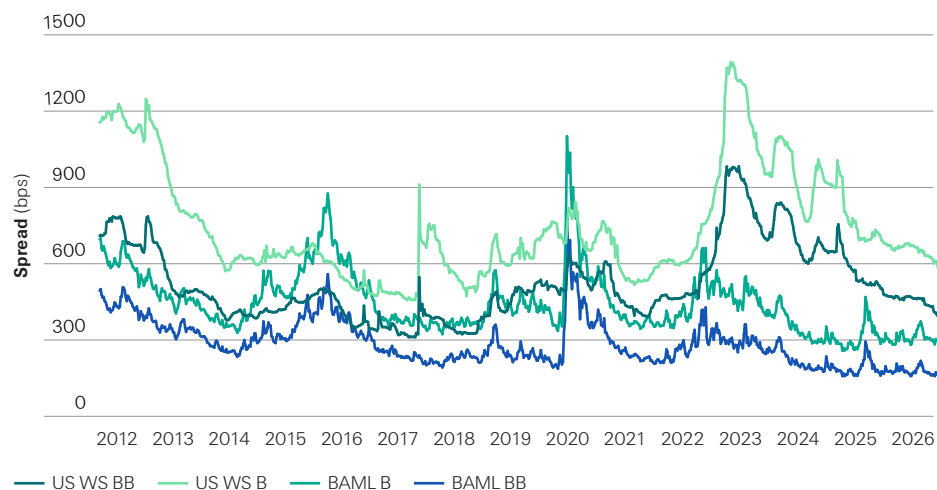


Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets as of June 30, 2026

Note: Swiss Re Cat Bond Indices contain only nat cat, interest-bearing bonds. Zero-coupon and non-nat cat bonds are excluded (e.g. Life/Health, Cyber). Seasonally-adjusted spread used. Bonds with seasonally-adjusted bid spread increases of 250% or greater from issuance have been excluded.

Figure 12 presents the average secondary market spreads for US wind-exposed catastrophe bonds, categorized into two risk tiers based on expected loss. During the first half of 2026, catastrophe bond spreads continued to tighten modestly across both risk buckets. Even with this ongoing compression, catastrophe bonds have continued to deliver spreads significantly above the BofA Merrill Lynch High Yield Indices, again underscoring their ability to provide attractive risk-adjusted returns and diversification benefits to fixed income portfolios.

Figure 12
Relative Value Indices:
Swiss Re Composite



Source: Swiss Re Capital Markets, as of June 30, 2026; Bank of America Merrill Lynch US High Yield B and BB Indices

Notes:

1. Swiss Re Capital Markets pricing indications only. Average seasonally adjusted spread used.
2. USWS B Rated Comp contains bonds with at least 1 year to maturity that have non-zero exposure to US WS and an EL between 181-375 bps (or with an actual B rating, regardless of EL).
3. USWS BB Rated Comp contains bonds with at least 1 year to maturity that have non-zero exposure to US WS and an EL between 16-180 bps (or with an actual BB rating, regardless of EL).
4. BofA Merrill Lynch High Yield Option Adjusted Spread via the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis website
5. Bonds with interest spread movement since issuance of greater than 200% or less than or equal to -100% have been excluded.
6. Non-natural catastrophe bonds have been excluded. Bonds with 90% or greater contribution to EL from Wildfire have been excluded. Sanders Re aggregate bonds have been excluded.
7. Bonanza Re 2020-2 B, 2021-1 B, 2023-1 B; Topanga Re 2021-1 B; Herbie Re 2020-1 A; Everglades Re 2023-1 A, 2023-2 A; Wrigley Re 2023-1 B; Aragonite Re 2024-1 A; Marlon 2024-1 B; have all been excluded.

Deal spotlight

Figure 13

Transaction Summary of Meritage Re Ltd 2026-1

Issuer:	Meritage Re Ltd.
Sponsor:	GeoVera Nova
Format:	144A
Peril:	US Wind
Trigger Type:	Indemnity; Per Occurrence
Tenor:	3 years
Total Size:	USD 200m
Initial Expected Loss:	1.89% (Base Case) / 2.15% (AIR WSST)
Initial Risk Interest Spread:	550 bps

The recently formed GeoVera Nova, a highly diversified A.M. Best-rated insurance group, pursued a catastrophe bond issuance to bolster its named storm reinsurance coverage. The first transaction by GeoVera Nova to cover wind exposures provides the sponsor with fully collateralized, multi-year protection against US named storm events.

Meritage Re 2026-1 covers the entity's "master blend" of complementary US wind exposures, sourced through the SafePort Homeowners and Business Owners Policy (BOP), GeoVera E&S Residential, GeoVera Commercial Residential, and AmRisc E&S Commercial businesses. During the marketing phase, GeoVera Nova successfully articulated the rationale for combining the A.M. Best-rated carriers and merging the MGA operations with the majority of the business underwritten by SageSure, the continuity and integrity of the product offering and the opportunities for future growth. SRCM supported GeoVera Nova in conveying its underwriting track-record with a focus on the specificities of E&S policy forms such as its proprietary roof payment schedule.

The transaction received substantial investor support and priced at 550 basis points, which was 75 basis points below the mid-range of the initial guidance of 600-650 basis points.

Figure 14

Transaction Summary of Gateway Re Ltd 2026-1

Issuer:	Gateway Re Ltd.
Sponsor:	SureChoice Underwriters Reciprocal Exchange, Elevate Reciprocal Exchange, and SafeChoice Insurance Company
Format:	144A
Peril:	Class AAAA, Class AAA-1: US Wind Class AAA-2, Class AA and Class A: US Wind, US Earthquake, US Severe Thunderstorm, US Wildfire and US Winter Storm
Trigger Type:	Indemnity; Per Occurrence and, for the Class AAA-2 Notes only, Per Occurrence and Annual Aggregate (3 rd event)
Tenor:	3 years
Total Size:	USD 670m
Initial Expected Loss:	Class AAAA: 0.65% (Base Case) / 0.77% (AIR WSST) Class AAA-1: 0.93% (Base Case) / 1.10% (AIR WSST) Class AAA-2: 2.85% (Base Case) / 3.43% (AIR WSST) Class AA: 2.45% (Base Case) / 2.78% (AIR WSST) Class A: 6.17% (Base Case) / 6.82% (AIR WSST)
Initial Risk Interest Spread:	Class AAAA: 350 bps Class AAA-1: 425 bps Class AAA-2: 625 bps Class AA: 650 bps Class A: 1000 bps

Gateway Re 2026-1 is SageSure's 12th catastrophe bond issuance through the Gateway Re program, with the transaction providing collateralized reinsurance protection across five classes. Building on the USD 520 million Gateway Re 2025-1 catastrophe bond which has provided valuable named storm coverage, the USD 670 million Gateway Re 2026-1 issuance is the first to significantly broaden the franchise's peril base to All Named Perils (ANP) defined as named storm, earthquakes, severe convective storm, wildfire, and winter storm.

Further, Class AAA-2 features a shared limit structure for which the same limit provides both remote, per occurrence protection on 1st event basis as well as 3rd event and subsequent event, capped annual aggregate coverage.

The successful placement of all five classes with different risk profiles demonstrates the catastrophe bond market's ability and willingness to provide broader coverage across the reinsurance program for trusted sponsors.

For more information

Specialists throughout Swiss Re Capital Markets are available for consultation on bespoke ILS solutions, and they invite a dialogue on the subject with sponsors and investors alike. For more information, please contact the person in your region listed below.

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An investment in Insurance-Linked Securities involves potentially significant risks for an investor, including but not limited to the following:

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- Maturities of Insurance-Linked Securities may be extended without the prior consent of the investor.
- Insurance-Linked Securities may be redeemed before their maturity date (including before any extension of such maturity date by the issuer).
- If Insurance-Linked Securities are redeemed before maturity, the interest rate payable to investors under the Insurance-Linked Securities will be reduced.
- Investors have limited recourse to assets of an issuer of Insurance-Linked Securities and no recourse to assets of the counterparties to the underlying risk-transfer agreements to which such Insurance-Linked Securities relate.
- If an issuer of Insurance-Linked Securities becomes insolvent, investors may lose some or all of their investment.
- Investors may be required to consolidate an issuer of Insurance-Linked Securities for accounting purposes under certain circumstances.
- An investment in Insurance-Linked Securities may have adverse tax consequences for investors.
- Any claim you have against an issuer of Insurance-Linked Securities in the event of the issuer's insolvency will be junior to any claim of a counterparty to the underlying risk-transfer agreements to which such Insurance-Linked Securities relate.
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